

TEMPORARY NAMES

- Scientists often need to refer to elements that have not yet been discovered. These elements are given **temporary names** by an organization called **IUPAC** (The International Union of Pure and Applied Chemistry). Even after these elements are discovered, their names and symbols must be approved by IUPAC before they are accepted by scientists throughout the world.

- Three-letter symbols, corresponding to their temporary names, are assigned to elements before they are given official names. Hassium's temporary name was **unniloctium**, with the symbol "**Uno**".

- Until it was named in 2004, Roentgenium was known as **unununium**, and its symbol was "Uuu". Unununium corresponds to the element's atomic number 111.

- Before they were officially named, flerovium and livermorium were called **ununquadium** and **ununhexium**, Latin words for their respective atomic numbers 114 and 116.

- When element 119 is discovered in the future, it will be first known as **ununennium**, with the symbol "Uue". Element 120 will be **unbinilium**, with the symbol "Ubn".

FROM PLACES

- **Polonium** is named after **Poland**.

- **Gallium** is named after "**Gallia**", the Latin name for France.

- **Lutetium** is derived from "**Lutetia**", the Roman name for Paris.

UNUSUAL SYMBOLS

- Sodium's symbol (**Na**) comes from its Latin name "natrium". The word is itself derived from the Arabic word "**natrun**", meaning "headache" – sodium carbonate was an ancient remedy for a sore head.

- The symbols for iron (**Fe**) and copper (**Cu**) come from the Latin words for these metals, "**ferrum**" and "**cuprum**". The symbols for silver (**Ag**) and gold (**Au**) are also based on their Latin names, "**argentum**" and "**aurum**".

- Tungsten's symbol is **W** because it is called "**Wolfram**" in German, which means "wolf soot".

- Tin's symbol (**Sn**) is an abbreviation of its Latin name "**stannum**".

- Potassium's symbol (**K**) comes from the Latin word "**kalium**", which means "ash".